$1 million for a robot car that could cross 150 miles.

> The best one went 7.32 miles.

No vehicle finished. The prize went unclaimed.

7.32 mi

Furthest run: Carnegie Mellon's Sandstorm, stuck on a rock

"Self-driving cars are decades away."

Ran it again and doubled the prize to $2 million.

A 132-mile course. Five vehicles finished.

2004

7.32 miles, no finisher

2005

132 miles, 5 finished

Stanford's Stanley takes the $2 million.

< 7 hours

Winning time over 132 miles

> Team lead: Sebastian Thrun.

From desert race to paid rides.

2004	7.32 mi
2005	5 finish
2007	6 finish
Feb 2026	~400K

The failure was the scoreboard.

YOUR RULE

For every AI pilot that "failed":

1. Measure how far it got
2. Publish the result
3. Fix one thing and rerun it

Share with your team ↓